

# KOR Structural — West Coast Executive Brief & San Diego Trip Playbook

For: Jim DesRoches, Principal · Trip: San Diego, June 29 – July 1, 2026 · Compiled: 2026-06-26 · INTERNAL

This is the cover for an 8-dossier packet: two market strategy dossiers (San Diego, Los Angeles) and six firm dossiers (H+W Engineering, Pinnacle International, Bosa Development, Kennedy Wilson, Greystar, Trammell Crow). Read this first; it tells you what matters and in what order.

## The one-page thesis

KOR’s West Coast opportunity is **not a cold expansion** — it is a **relationship-conversion play**, and it runs on a single structural truth that repeats across both markets:

Vancouver developers import their Vancouver structural engineer into California — and that engineer (Glotman Simpson) has an LA office but *no San Diego office*. KOR can be in San Diego. That gap is the wedge.

Everything in the packet resolves into **two motions**:

- 1. **ELEVATE what KOR already holds — the JWDA channel, anchored by the Greystar incumbency.** KOR is the structural engineer on **multiple JWDA-designed San Diego towers across four developers**, and the engine is the *architect*: **JWDA keeps picking KOR when it has discretion**, carrying KOR from developer to developer. Two pieces are rock-solid: (a) **Greystar** — KOR is SE on **525 Olive** (completed 2022) and **6th & Palm** (under construction to 2028), both Greystar developments; and (b) **The Lindley** (37-story) — though its developer was **Toll Brothers + PGIM**, *not* Kennedy Wilson (KW is a later owner). Convert the JWDA relationship into firm-level preferred-engineer status and elevate Greystar to preferred vendor + a Vancouver door.
- 2. **DISPLACE the out-of-town incumbent where it has no local feet — Glotman Simpson.** Pinnacle and Bosa import **Glotman Simpson**, which has an **LA office but no San Diego office** and has served ~50 SD high-rises from Vancouver/LA. *That* is the clean wedge. **KPFF and DCI both have San Diego offices** (since 1994 and 2001), so they are *not* “no-office” targets — displace them on principal attention and the under-served mid-tier, not presence.

San Diego is **near-term revenue**; Los Angeles is a **patient 2027+ build** (owner-direct seismic retrofit + the same Vancouver-relationship lever, via Onni).

## Market verdicts

|             | San Diego                                                                                                                                          | Los Angeles                                                                               |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Posture     | Near-term — two live incumbencies + warm architect (JWDA, DBRDS)                                                                                   | Patient build — presence, not licensure, is the gate (Markulin holds CA SE)               |
| #1 entry    | Convert the <b>JWDA architect channel</b> into a tower pipeline (KOR already SE on 4 JWDA towers)                                                  | Owner-direct <b>NDC seismic retrofit</b> (~1,400 buildings, ~2028 cliff, \$100–400K each) |
| Displace    | <b>Glotman Simpson</b> (LA office, <i>no SD office</i> — the clean wedge). KPFF/DCI have SD offices → compete on principal attention, not presence | Englekirk/WSP boutique accounts (closing 2026 window)                                     |
| White space | <b>Mass timber</b> (no SD incumbent; CALGreen 2026 carbon rule) + mid-rise podium tier                                                             | Woodframe/podium under SB 79; <b>Onni</b> re-engagement (Glotman capacity-locked)         |
| Avoid       | Trophy towers (KPFF), NAVFAC, K-12/HCAI (credential gates)                                                                                         | K-12 (DSA), HCAI hospitals, life-science new-build (oversupply)                           |

## San Diego trip — who to see and what to ask (priority order)

- 1. **JWDA / Joseph Wong Design Associates — the warmest relationship and the real engine.** KOR is the SE on **four JWDA towers across four developers** (The Lindley, 525 Olive, 800 Broadway, Simone). JWDA drives the KOR pick when it has discretion. Ask: “What’s next in the JWDA pipeline — and can we be your standing structural team on it?” The goal is firm-level preferred-engineer status with JWDA, which then carries KOR developer-to-developer. (Note: the Bosa towers JWDA designs — Diega, Andia — are locked to Glotman Simpson and not winnable through JWDA.)

2. **DBRDS (De Bartolo + Rimanic) — warm, KOR on bid list, but no open seat today.** KPFF is DBRDS's firm-level standing SE across 9+ projects; displacing it needs a **principal-level intro to De Bartolo / Rimanic**, not an RFP response. *Ask:* get in front of the principals; position for the next project where the SE isn't already committed. **Correction for the trip:** the rumored "1650 Hotel Circle South" does **not exist** — the real project is **1650 Hotel Circle North** (City PRJ-1130310, 12-story mixed-use, SDP filed 2025). The DBRDS-as-architect link is **unverified** — do not assert it; confirm with the referral source.
3. **Greystar — KOR's strongest verified developer incumbency; elevate it.** Unlike Kennedy Wilson, this one is solid: KOR is the SE on **525 Olive** (20-story, completed 2022, SDBJ "Best Multifamily") and **6th & Palm** (20-story, under construction to 2028) — both **Greystar developments, JWDA architect, invoiced via Greystar Development West** (a Deltek client entity). *Ask Adam Covington (Sr Dir, SD) / Jerry Brand (Exec Dir Dev & Construction, Western Region):* firm-level preferred-vendor status + what's next in the SD pipeline; and open the **Vancouver** concrete-highrise door via **John Wilbeck (MD Canada)** — Covington's warm intro to Wilbeck is worth more than any cold outreach.
4. **Pinnacle / Bosa — displacement, armed with the Glotman gap.** Both import **Glotman Simpson, which has no San Diego office** (LA only). *Opening probe:* "Who did you have on structural for [Andia / Pacific Heights], and who's lined up for the next one?" KOR being *in San Diego* + the prior Bosa relationship (Ryan Bosa testimonial; KOR was SE on Evolution, Calgary) is the in.
5. **H+W Engineering — lock the teaming partner.** MEP, complementary, gateway is **Mandy Serrano → principals Tom Harmon / Bryan Wayne**. *Ask:* a preferred-teaming arrangement for SD multifamily/institutional; a joint pitch to Miller Hull; a warm intro to HG Fenton.

**Two newly-surfaced San Diego openings worth a call (open SE seats, not yet committed):**

- **Safdie Rabines Architects** — marquee commissions with **no structural engineer named yet:** Oceanside Museum of Art expansion, San Diego Museum of Art (Balboa Park) renovation, and Midway Rising. Genuine open seats; KOR's cultural/heritage pedigree fits.
- **AC Martin** — opened a **new San Diego office (~late 2023)** whose SE network isn't locked yet; multifamily/mixed-use is their top sector. Target **Sami Khoury** and **Gilbert Rocca** early.

*(Kennedy Wilson and Trammell Crow are primarily LA-weighted relationships — see their dossiers. Important correction: **KOR's SD tower credit on The Lindley came via JWDA for a Toll Brothers/PGIM development — not for Kennedy Wilson.** Treat KW as a relationship to build, not an SD incumbency to "protect.")*

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## Before anything closes — three confirmations

1. **California registration is the gate.** Confirm KOR's CA SE coverage (Markulin holds it), and note DSA (schools) / HCAI (acute-care) credentialing gates before chasing those segments.
2. **SE-of-record is unpublished for ~90% of named SD projects.** Incumbencies asserted in the dossiers are sourced where a firm/architect/award names them; the rest are flagged UNVERIFIED — confirm via SEAOSD/EGBC network and permit records, not web search.
3. **Manage the EGBC-2019 disclosure** when leading with seismic/heritage credentials.